

Testimony of Abi Thomas (Philadelphia Regional Hearing)

Hi everyone, my name is Abi and I live in Northeast Philly. As a concerned voter, I am here to speak about the current redistricting efforts being made for us. I know for a fact that I, and many people who live in my neighborhood, Northeast Philadelphia and the greater Philly area ask for fairness out of all things. When it comes to the matter of redistricting, we ask for contiguity, we ask for preservation of counties and our communities. Although these asks don't seem to be that much to ask for, just know if they're not delivered, voters are watching. What we are not asking for is gerrymandering, especially in a state like Pennsylvania, where every election is one that has to be hard won. We are aware of gerrymandering and its current impact in the past years as voters in our state. We speak out against this in particular because we know this impacts our local politics, where this impacts a voter like me, arguably, the most. We want legislation, bills and so forth to be able to get passed that can actually help my city and its voters. But this can only be done if we are redistricted in the ways that I mentioned previously. The quicker this is done fairly, keeping our communities together and supporting the people of the Commonwealth, the quicker our elected representatives can get back to work helping us. Voters are tired of the political games, and all we ask for are fair districts. As I speak before you as a younger voter, know that the younger generations of voters are watching and expect you to deliver what we want and need. We are asking for the bare minimum as we shouldn't have to fight for fair districts to begin with, thank you for your time.